

SAFER?

**no room for complacency.
anges need to be carried out.**



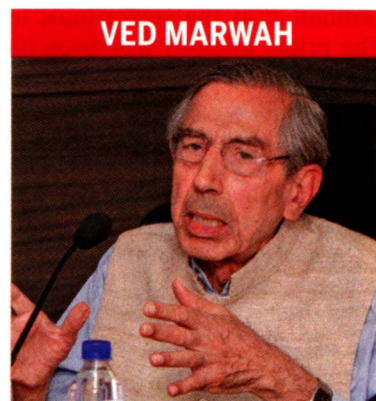
THE 26/11 TERROR STRIKE IN MUMBAI

REUTERS

the Government should not be complacent. The danger is very much there and the moment things settle down in our neighbourhood, we will be a big target for the jihadis. The apparatus inside the country is there; it hasn't been identified or eliminated. This can be activated at an opportune moment. For that the Government still needs to do a number of steps. Among them is that the Government needs to

give the National Anti-Terrorism Agency a mandate to keep an eye on developments within the country and in the world. It should analyse every incident and take steps to strengthen our preparedness. We need a comprehensive law which is understood by the investigative agencies, the prosecution and the courts. We need a broad national consensus among all political parties and they should not make political capital out of a terror incident. **Satish Nambiar, Former Deputy Chief of the Army Staff:** Last time we started on the premise that our focus should be on prevention. I have been articulating this for sometime and this is relevant. Now it's almost a year and we have not had a major strike. So let us credit the establishment. I would also like to see us evolve a pre-emptive strategy and develop a capability for pre-emptive strikes on terrorists dealing with the jihadi groups. This means that we have to find out where they are located and where their leadership is. If we have not done that then there is something seriously wrong. The Air Force has the capability to effect precision attacks. We must focus on developing it because we cannot wait for things to happen. We must pre-empt terror attacks.

Brahma Chellaney, Professor, Strategic Studies, Centre for Policy Studies: There has been no terror attack for nearly 11 months but that doesn't mean that India is less vulnerable to terror attacks since we last met. The vulnerability level remains the same, but are we better prepared? Yes, we are better prepared not institutionally but at the level of Governmental response. It goes to show that if you put a professional in charge of a ministry he or she can make a difference. Ever since Chidambaram took over as the home minister, we have seen a conscious effort to revamp India's internal security policy. He began from scratch and today knows exactly what is happening. Plus, he has put everybody under pressure. Every morning, he meets the heads of different agencies and the National Security Adviser (NSA). Therefore, for the first time there's co-



VED MARWAH

“Credit goes to the Centre and recent developments in Pakistan where the jihadis are fighting for survival.

As the Home Minister, Chidambaram has helped in creating a feeling of urgency in the security agencies.

If the Pakistan Army wins against the Taliban, we will have trouble and if the jihadis win, of course, we will have more trouble.

A consensus among all parties is needed. They should not use a terror incident for political gains.

We need a comprehensive law which is easily understood by the investigative agencies, the prosecution and the courts.”